Creating Reports and Dashboards for Data Visualization in Zoho Creator

Case Study 12

Aim

To create reports and dashboards in Zoho Creator that present business data clearly through tables and charts.

Objective

- Understand different report types in Zoho Creator.
- Create list, summary and chart reports from form data.
- Apply filters, grouping, sorting and quick views.
- Combine multiple visuals into a dashboard page.

Selected Application

Sales and Inventory Management App using the Order form with fields: Order ID, Customer, Product, Quantity, Amount, Region, Order Date and Status.

Sample Data

Order ID	Customer	Product	Qty	Amount (₹)	Region	Status
1001	Asha Traders	Laptop	2	1,20,000	South	Delivered
1002	Rao Stores	Printer	5	60,000	West	Pending
1003	Kiran Mart	Mouse	20	10,000	South	Delivered
1004	City Mart	Laptop	1	60,000	North	Cancelled
1005	Asha Traders	Keyboard	10	15,000	South	Pending

Sample records for demonstration; enter similar data in the application to generate the reports.

Report Types in Zoho Creator

Report Type	Description	Use Case
List	Records in a table with search and filter	View all orders
Grid	Spreadsheet-like inline editing	Quick data editing
Calendar	Records shown by date	Delivery schedule
Kanban	Cards grouped by a field in columns	Order status board
Summary	Grouped records with totals / counts	Sales by region
Chart	Bar, line, pie, funnel, etc.	Revenue trends
Pivot	Cross-tabulation of data	Region × product sales
Map / Timeline	Location or time-based view	Customer locations

Procedure

A. Creating Reports

1 Click **Create Report**, choose the Order form as source and select the report type.

2 **List report:** select columns, set sorting (latest first), add a quick view filter for Status and Region.

3 **Kanban report:** group by Status (Pending, Delivered, Cancelled).

4. **Chart reports:** a bar chart of Amount by Region, a pie chart of Orders by Status and a line chart of Amount by Order Date.
5. Optionally add a **Summary** section showing the sum of Amount and the count of orders.

B. Creating a Dashboard

1. Create a new **Page** named “Sales Dashboard”.
2. From the page builder, drag the three charts, a Kanban report and text-based KPI blocks (Total Sales, Orders, Pending Orders).
3. Arrange them in a grid layout, apply a consistent colour theme and add titles.
4. Add filters (for example, region or date range) so that all charts respond to selection.
5. Add the dashboard to the “Reports” menu section and set access for managers.

Dashboard Layout

Top row: KPI blocks	Total Sales	Total Orders	Pending Orders
Middle row: charts	Sales by Region (Bar)	Orders by Status (Pie)	Sales Trend (Line)
Bottom row: report	Orders Kanban / List report (embedded)		

Observations

- Charts update in real time when new orders are added.
- The Pending status can be quickly identified in the Kanban view.
- Filters and grouping help managers analyze data by region, product or period.
- Choosing the right chart type (bar for comparison, pie for share, line for trend) improves readability.

Note: Zoho Creator's interface is updated regularly, so menu names may differ slightly between versions. Add your own screenshots of each step when submitting.

Results

- List, Kanban, summary and chart reports were created from the Order form.
- A Sales Dashboard combining KPIs, charts and reports was designed.
- Data was presented in a clear, interactive format supporting quick decisions.

Conclusion

Reports and dashboards turn raw data into insight. Zoho Creator's report types and page builder allow users to create interactive visualizations without coding, helping managers monitor performance and take timely decisions.